

3 Claude Agent Modes

Copy any prompt template below, replace the placeholders in [BRACKETS] with your own details, and paste into Claude Code.

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Mode 01

Sub-Agent

Claude spawns a temporary worker, hands it a single task, and returns the result to your main chat. Claude decides on its own whether to spawn a sub-agent, when to do it, and in what order. Your main context stays clean.

HOW TO ACCESS IT

Type 'use subagents' in any Claude Code prompt. Claude handles the rest. No setup file needed. Works in any Claude Code session.

PROMPT TEMPLATES

```
use subagents Research [YOUR TOPIC] and return a 3-bullet summary of the most important facts for someone in [YOUR ROLE / INDUSTRY].
```

For researchers and analysts

```
use subagents Review the [TYPE OF FILE OR CODE] in [FILE PATH OR FOLDER] and flag any errors, inconsistencies, or improvements.
```

For developers and technical users

```
use subagents Write a first draft of [TYPE OF CONTENT] about [YOUR TOPIC] for an audience of [YOUR AUDIENCE]. Tone: [YOUR PREFERRED TONE].
```

For content creators and marketers

```
use subagents Compare [OPTION A] and [OPTION B] for [YOUR USE CASE] and return a recommendation with 3 supporting reasons.
```

For decision-making tasks

Pro tip: Sub-agents are best for one-shot tasks you want handled without cluttering your main conversation. Use them when the job is clear, contained, and needs a fast answer.

Mode 02

Agent Team

A fixed roster of named specialists that Claude walks in the order you set. You create one .md file per role inside a .claude/agents/ folder in your project. Claude hands off from one specialist to the next down your chain.

HOW TO ACCESS IT

Type 'create agent team' in Claude Code and describe your roles. Claude will create the .claude/agents/ folder and generate one .md file per specialist. Each file defines the agent's name, role, and instructions. Edit them to fit your workflow, then fire the pipeline by name.

PROMPT TEMPLATES

```
create agent team I need a [NUMBER]-step pipeline for [YOUR WORKFLOW].  
Roles: [ROLE 1], [ROLE 2], [ROLE 3]. Each role should [BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF  
WHAT EACH ROLE DOES].
```

For building a new pipeline from scratch

```
Run my agent team pipeline on [INPUT OR TASK DESCRIPTION]. Start with [ROLE  
1] and pass the output down the chain to [FINAL ROLE].
```

For firing an existing pipeline

```
create agent team Build a content pipeline with these roles: 1. [STRATEGIST  
ROLE] who [WHAT THEY DO] 2. [WRITER ROLE] who [WHAT THEY DO] 3. [QA ROLE]  
who [WHAT THEY DO]
```

For content production workflows

```
Update my [AGENT NAME] agent in .claude/agents/ to also [NEW  
RESPONSIBILITY]. Keep the existing instructions and add this to the end.
```

For editing an existing agent role

Pro tip: Agent teams win when you run the same process repeatedly. Build it once, fire it daily. The more repeatable your workflow, the more leverage you get.

Mode 03

Dynamic Workflow

A script runs the operation in the background. It fans work out to up to 100 parallel workers, merges the results, and loops until the job is done. Your code holds the loops and conditionals, not Claude. This mode shipped with Opus 4.8.

HOW TO ACCESS IT

Type 'run a workflow' and describe what you want built. Claude will write the script for you. You can also write your own script and call Claude as the worker inside each iteration. Best suited for tasks with many items, independent checks, or parallel processing needs.

PROMPT TEMPLATES

```
run a workflow I have a list of [NUMBER] [TYPE OF ITEMS] in [FILE OR SOURCE]. Process each one by [TASK DESCRIPTION] and merge the results into [OUTPUT FORMAT].
```

For bulk processing tasks

```
run a workflow Build a script that fans out to [NUMBER] workers, each processing [TASK] on [INPUT TYPE], then merges results and flags any output that fails [YOUR QUALITY CHECK].
```

For parallel processing with verification

```
run a workflow I need to process [YOUR DATASET OR LIST] and have independent agents verify each output before it is accepted. Flag anything that does not meet [YOUR CRITERIA].
```

For tasks requiring independent QA

```
run a workflow Loop through [YOUR INPUT SOURCE] until [YOUR COMPLETION CONDITION]. At each step, [TASK DESCRIPTION]. Stop when [EXIT CONDITION].
```

For iterative or looping tasks

Pro tip: Dynamic workflows are for scale. If you are processing dozens or hundreds of items and need independent checks on the output, this is the right mode. Start with agent teams. Upgrade to workflows when volume demands it.

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